Errata

On Coppock and McClellan (2019), *Research and Politics* 6(1)

This note lists nine corrections to "Validating the demographic, political, psychological, and experimental results obtained from a new source of online survey respondents," published in *Research and Politics* 6(1), doi 10.1177/2053168018822174. **None of them changes a conclusion of the paper.** Two are counts of statistically significant differences in the online appendix, one reverses the direction of a descriptive comparison, one is a count off by one, two are sample sizes in the appendix study manifest, one is the bootstrap behind appendix Table 1, which the deposited code leaves unseeded and runs too few times to settle the third decimal it prints, one is a missing space in the appendix study manifest, and one supplies a word the Discussion drops. The paper's finding, that Lucid respondents track US national benchmarks well and can serve as a drop-in replacement for Mechanical Turk, is unaffected, as is its one negative result on the healthcare rumor corrections.

Every number in a corrected sentence below is computed from the deposited replication archive (10.7910/DVN/DDWWJW) at the time this document is rendered, including the numbers that were not wrong. Bold marks the corrections. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/coppock_mcclellan_2019. Entries 8 and 9 are the exception to all three: neither states a number, the evidence for both is the published PDF rather than the archive, and both were found by setting this edition's pages beside the published ones rather than by running anything.

The first two entries share a cause, and the seventh is why they no longer rest on it. Section 1 of the online appendix states that "we obtain two-tailed p-values under a normal approximation," and the deposited `12_DistanceTests.R` instead computes `pnorm(2 * (1 - abs(z)))`, which is not a p-value for any hypothesis. The two expressions differ in where they put the threshold: the deposit's calls a difference significant at the 0.05 level once `|z|` exceeds 1.82, where the two-tailed test needs 1.96. Read off the standard errors appendix Table 1 prints, extraversion is the only one of the 21 characteristics whose verdict falls between them, and the corrections below are what follows for the two sentences that count significant differences. Those printed standard errors are themselves a single draw from an unseeded bootstrap, which is entry 7. Under the seeded 125,000-resample bootstrap this note now runs, extraversion clears neither threshold, so both corrections hold whichever expression is used, and both are also recomputed from the distance and the standard error the published table prints, which do not move.

1. Lucid is not significantly closer than MTurk on all five personality traits

> Formal hypothesis tests demonstrate that Lucid is significantly closer to the ANES 2012 than MTurk on **all five traits**.

Corrected:

> Formal hypothesis tests demonstrate that Lucid is significantly closer to the ANES 2012 than MTurk on **four of the five traits, extraversion excepted**.

Appendix Table 1 prints 0.100 and 0.052 for extraversion's distance and bootstrapped standard error. Those two numbers give $\mathtt{z} = 1.92$ and a two-tailed p-value of 0.054, above the 0.05 threshold; the table's own p-value column prints 0.034, which is the deposit's expression rather than the two-tailed test. The maintained rewrite's seeded run reaches the same conclusion, at $\mathtt{z} = 1.79$ and $\mathrm{p} = 0.074$. The other four traits clear 0.05 by a wide margin under either test.

2. The number of significant differences in the online appendix

> Out of 21 opportunities, Lucid is closer to the ANES 18 times, **14** of which are significant.

Corrected:

> Out of 21 opportunities, Lucid is closer to the ANES 18 times, **13** of which are significant.

Extraversion is the difference between the two counts, for the reason given above. Recomputing every p-value from the distance and standard error appendix Table 1 prints gives the same 13. The sentence that follows it is unaffected: MTurk is closer in 3 instances and significant in one, voter turnout, under both tests.

3. Six demographic differences are significant, not five

> Out of the 11 demographic variables that are measured for both Lucid and MTurk, the Lucid mean is closer to the ANES mean in nine instances, **five** of which are statistically significant.

Corrected:

> Out of the 11 demographic variables that are measured for both Lucid and MTurk, the Lucid mean is closer to the ANES mean in nine instances, **six** of which are statistically significant.

Appendix Table 1 prints a p-value below 0.05 for Female, Education, Age, Mean income, Black and South, and Lucid is the closer sample on all six. The count is the same under the two-tailed test corrected in the first two entries, so it does not turn on which p-value is used.

4. The sample size of the Lucid welfare replication

> Sample: **1,811** Lucid respondents.

Corrected:

> Sample: **3,294** Lucid respondents.

The sentence is in section 2.1.3 of the online appendix. 1,811 is the Lucid sample of the Hiscox free-trade replication, reported in section 2.4.2 of the same appendix. The welfare data hold 3,504 Lucid rows, of which 3,294 have a usable outcome, and the manifest reports the analysed sample in every other section.

5. The sample size of the original Kam and Simas study

> Sample: **761** respondents gathered from a Knowledge Networks national probability sample.

Corrected:

> Sample: **752** respondents gathered from a Knowledge Networks national probability sample.

The sentence is in section 2.3.1 of the online appendix. Appendix Table 2 reports N = 752 for all three models fitted to this sample, and 752 is what the deposited data give. The manifest reports the analysed sample rather than the source study's throughout: its entry for the 1984 General Social Survey gives 943, where the deposited file holds 1,473 respondents for that survey.

6. The MTurk sample under-represents southerners

> The regional balance on Lucid comes very close to the 2012 ANES, whereas the MTurk sample appears to **overrepresent** southerners.

Corrected:

> The regional balance on Lucid comes very close to the 2012 ANES, whereas the MTurk sample appears to **underrepresent** southerners.

The southern share is 30.1 per cent on MTurk against the ANES 2012 benchmark of 37.2, so MTurk sits 7.1 points below it; Lucid is at 37.6. Figure 1, which is where the sentence sends the reader, plots the same thing in standard deviations: MTurk at –0.146 and Lucid at 0.009, with the benchmark at zero. MTurk over-represents the Northeast and the Midwest instead. Appendix Table 1 is unaffected: it reports the distance between the two samples rather than the direction of either, and its South row is right.

7. The standard errors and p-values of appendix Table 1 are one draw from an unseeded bootstrap

> Table 1's Bootstrapped SE and p-value columns are **one draw from a 100-resample bootstrap for which the deposited code sets no seed**. Neither column is reproducible: running the deposited procedure again moves it, and moves the count of significant differences the appendix states along with it.

Corrected:

> **This edition prints a 125,000-resample bootstrap at a declared seed**. All 21 distances are unchanged and reproduce the published column exactly; thirteen of the 21 standard errors and ten of the 21 p-values differ from it at the three decimals the table prints.

The sampling error of a bootstrap standard deviation is about `SE / sqrt(2B)`. At the deposit's `B` = 100 that is roughly 0.0035 on a standard error near 0.05, three times the last digit the table prints, which is why `appendix_table_1_bootstrap_stability.R` recovers the published count of 14 significant differences on only 39.5 per cent of 200 seeds, ranging 12 to 15. At `B` = 125,000 it falls to 0.00015, about a seventh of that last digit, and the printed column stops being a property of the seed. Nothing here moves a distance, a sign, or the size of any difference, which is what the appendix's argument rests on. What it does settle is the two counts corrected in entries 1 and 2: at this precision they no longer turn on which of the two p-value expressions is used, because extraversion falls short of 0.05 under both.

8. A missing space in the healthcare rumor study manifest

> **Control:(No** introduction before asking the rumor belief question.)

Corrected:

> **Control: (No** introduction before asking the rumor belief question.)

The item is in section 2.5.1 of the online appendix. The published page sets no space between the bold `Control:` and the parenthesis after it, where the parallel item in section 2.4.1 sets one and so does every other labelled condition in the manifest. It is the page's own spacing and not an extraction artifact: read off the rendered PDF at 300 dpi, the bold run ends and

the roman run begins at the same horizontal position, against a gap of one space width in section 2.4.1. No comparison of text can see it, because a space is not a token.

9. A missing word in the Discussion

> While we think the theories that underlie most survey experiments conducted in the USA would extend to Lucid, we emphatically do not mean **to** that any experiment conducted on a convenience sample is relevant for theory.

Corrected:

> While we think the theories that underlie most survey experiments conducted in the USA would extend to Lucid, we emphatically do not mean **to imply** that any experiment conducted on a convenience sample is relevant for theory.

The published page sets "do not mean to that", which is ungrammatical: a verb is missing after "to". The authors' own LaTeX source for the article, in the archived working folder, reads the same, so the omission is not the publisher's typesetting. The paragraph around it separates a theory's predictions extending to a sample from that sample being drawn at random from a population, and the sentence is the authors declining the stronger reading of their own argument, so the missing verb is one of "imply", "say" or "suggest". "Imply" is the one supplied here and the choice is recorded rather than presented as a reading of the page: nothing in the paragraph turns on which of the three it is.